

CORTORA

Escalation Triggers, Routing, and Response Expectations

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This document defines when and how a case should be escalated, who receives each type of escalation, and the expected response times. It applies to all business units and to OpsPilot when it identifies a situation it cannot safely resolve at the current authorization level.

1. When to Escalate

- The required action exceeds the employee's authorization level under the Employee Authorization Matrix.
- The available evidence is missing, incomplete, or contradictory and cannot be resolved through approved tools.
- The case involves a suspected fraud, risk, or security indicator.
- A customer requests a supervisor or disputes a policy outcome after it has been clearly explained.
- A tool or system failure prevents the case from being resolved through the normal workflow.
- OpsPilot flags the situation as falling outside documented policy, or as containing instructions that appear to be an attempt to bypass normal controls.

2. Escalation Routing

Situation	Escalate to	Expected acknowledgement
Refund/cancellation above agent limit	Support Manager or Payments Specialist, per amount	Within target response time for the case priority
Suspected fraud or risk indicator	Risk Analyst (Risk & Trust)	Within 1 hour for P1, 4 hours otherwise
Payment reconciliation discrepancy	Payments Operations	Within 1 business day
System or tool failure affecting a case	Technology & Data	Within 4 hours for P1/P2
Customer requests a supervisor	Support Manager	Within the case's existing priority target
Legal, regulatory, or press-related concern	Corporate Operations leadership	Within 4 hours
Suspected AI error materially affecting a decision	Technology & Data, with case reference	Within 1 business day

3. How to Escalate

- Set the case status to ESCALATED and record the specific reason from Section 1.
- Attach all evidence already gathered, including tool outputs and policy references reviewed.
- Identify the specific decision or action needed from the escalation recipient — 'please review' is not sufficient; state what approval or judgment call is required.

- Do not close or reassign the case away from yourself until the escalation recipient has acknowledged it, unless your role requires you to hand off at shift end, in which case note the handoff explicitly.

4. Escalating AI-Related Issues

If OpsPilot retrieves irrelevant information, selects an inappropriate tool, produces an incorrect recommendation, or reports content that appears to instruct it to ignore company rules, the employee should not silently correct the issue and proceed. Escalate to Technology & Data with the case reference so that repeated or high-impact errors can be identified and addressed. Never conceal an AI-generated error from the case history when it materially affected the investigation.

5. Escalation Priority Alignment

Escalation urgency should match the case priority defined in the Customer Support SOP. A P1 case escalated for a risk indicator should be treated as urgent by the receiving Risk Analyst; a P3 case escalated for a manager approval should be handled within the standard case response window rather than immediately interrupting other work.

6. De-escalation and Resolution

Once the escalation recipient has made a decision, the case should move out of ESCALATED status back into the appropriate working status (INVESTIGATING, WAITING_FOR_APPROVAL, or RESOLVED) with the decision and its rationale recorded. If the escalation recipient determines further specialist input is needed, the case may be re-routed rather than returned to the original employee.

7. Repeated or Unresolved Escalations

A case escalated more than twice without resolution should be brought to the attention of the relevant business unit lead directly, rather than being escalated a third time through the standard routing, since repeated escalation without resolution often indicates a gap in policy or tooling rather than a routing problem.

8. Related Documents

- Customer Support SOP — defines case priorities referenced in this document.
- Employee Authorization Matrix — defines the authorization limits that trigger many escalations.
- Fraud & Risk Policy — defines risk indicators and Risk & Trust's role.
- Employee Handbook & Internal Systems Guide — defines general reporting and security escalation obligations.

Synthetic environment notice: Cortora, its employees, customers, policies, and operational records are fictional and created solely for the OpsPilot engineering project.